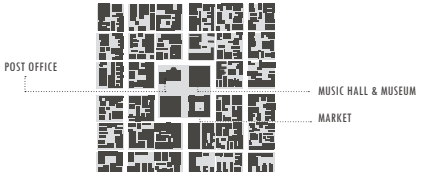
ALLEGHENY CENTER

Allegheny Center, located at the heart of Allegheny City and now Pittsburgh's North Side, has always been community oriented. The original plan for Allegheny's town center in 1828 consisted of a 36-square grid with a center public square. During the 1960s the area was majorly demolished and reconstructed, but still adhered to the original grid structure. Now soon to be home to Nova Place, a project representative of Pittsburgh's greater transformation, Allegheny Center is a hub of innovation and public gathering, with an influence that stretches far beyond the boundaries of the neighborhood.

ALLEGHENY POST OFFICE [1897] » CHILDREN'S MUSEUM OF PITTSBURGH [1972]

A change symbolic of Allegheny Center's transformation is that of the Allegheny Post Office into the Children's Museum of Pittsburgh. It marks the era of commercial urban development in Allegheny Center, and the changes that era had even on the buildings that survived demolition.



ALLEGHENY WEST

Allegheny West is one of the most historic neighborhoods in Pittsburgh, but has been transformed over its lifespan by the presence or absence of railroads. When rail transport exploded in the late 19th and early 20th centuries, Allegheny West was directly impacted by the roundhouses and large quantity of labor the rail hub called for. As the railroads have been moved to a lower grade than the surrounding neighborhood, and the central hub has moved elsewhere, Allegheny West has found itself neglected and divided from other, more well-off neighborhoods.

RAILWAY ROUNDHOUSES [MID 1800S] » USPS SECTIONAL CENTER [1960S]

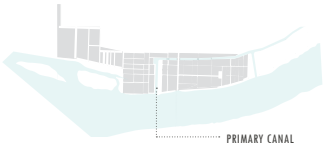
Allegheny West's railroad-based livelihood became the center for a giant building that serves as the USPS Sectional Center Facility. This currently serves and coordinates distribution to a large swath of Western Pennsylvania, but has very little benefit for Allegheny West itself.

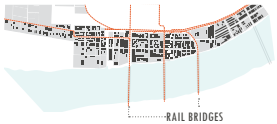
NORTH SHORE

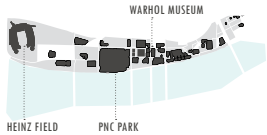
In its first era, North Shore development was catlyzed by its major canal, as the majority of Pittsburgh's commerce was water-based on the Ohio river. As railroads progressed, the canals were filled and the land extended to make room for transportation depots, and many bridges were built spanning the river. In today's world, trucking provides most of North Shore's transportation needs. North Shore today is a hyper-commercial area, home to Pittsburgh's sports arenas as well as several museums and parks. Little historic or residential presence is left.

VOLKWEIN'S, FRICK & LINDSAY BUILDING [1913] » ANDY WARHOL MUSEUM [1994]

The Volkswein's, Frick, and Lindsay Building was representative of the cultural and commercial hub that North Shore was as a part of Allegheny City. It served as a warehouse for oil, mill, and mine supplies. Today it is home to the Andy Warhol Museum, a center for culture and commerce.







CENTRAL NORTHSIDE

Central Northside, like Allegheny West, is a very historic and primarily residential Pittsburgh community - 73% of its current buildings were built before 1939. The neighborhood is a centerpiece of preservation efforts, and serves as a prime example for the benefit of historic preservation efforts to Pittsburgh's economy. Even with the growth of commercial areas in surrounding neighborhoods and some larger buildings within its own boundaries, Central Northside has retained its residential focus. Many of its jobs rely on its historic nature, and this relationship remains a focus moving into the future.

ALLEGHENY REGIONAL BRANCH [1890] » CARNEGIE LIBRARY [1907]

The Allegheny Regional Branch Library was a point of pride for Allegheny City prior to its annexation into Pittsburgh. It served as one of the founding libraries for the Carnegie system of libraries in Pittsburgh, and still remains an important community focal point today.

MANCHESTER

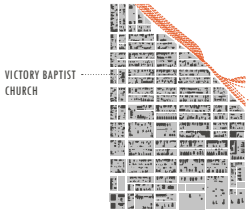
Manchester is also a historic residential neighborhood. Its zoning transitioned from a mix of residential and industrial uses to being almost entirely focused on high-density residential development. 52% of Manchester's buildings are from before 1939. Like Allegheny West, it has been isolated from the heavy commercial effects of the North Shore and Allegheny Center by Highway 279 on one side and railroads on the other. Present master plans aim to create a more vibrant community while maintaining a residential focus.

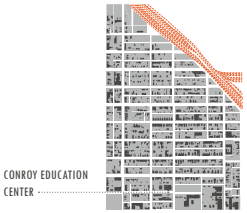
VICTORY BAPTIST CHURCH [1865]

The Victory Baptist Church was built during the Dutchtown Era of Allegheny City, as a cultural community center. It has survived to the present, and has been restored to resemble its original state - as well as its original function.

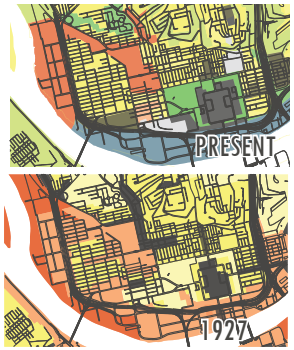
CONROY EDUCATION CENTER [1895]

The Conroy Education Center was built as Pittsburgh began to develop into an industrial city. It provided necessary public education to an ever more dense and residential area in Pittsburgh.





ZONING EVOLUTION



- HIGH DENSITY RESIDENTIAL
- LOW DENSITY RESIDENTIAL
- HEAVY INDUSTRY
- LIGHT INDUSTRY
- COMMERCIAL
- EDUCATIONAL/MEDICAL
- PARK/GREENSPACE
- HILLSIDE
- PUBLIC SPACE

HISTORY

800+

TOWN OF ALLEGHENY ESTABLISHED, 1784

Many of the town's lots were given as payment to veterans of the revolutionary war, and respect for veterans is a trend that continues strongly in Allegheny City until its incorporation to Pittsburgh, and remains visible in North Side's focus on historic preservation.

ALLEGHENY CITY INCORPORATED, 1840

Allegheny City became home to European immigrants who found work in the city's booming industries. John Redick's master plan for the city contained a 36-square grid with a central public square, as well as a post office and market house.

1850+

DUTCHTOWN, 1850

As the East Allegheny area was developed between 1850 and 1900, it was inhabited almost exclusively by German immigrants. The area came to be known as Dutchtown, and both business and residential districts were established.

BIG INDUSTRY, 1870

Entrepreneurs began to transform the economy. Previously, small craft-based factories in the city limits dominated production. These were quickly made obsolete by a large, organized industrial region that stretched in a 50-mile radius in Allegheny county. This furthered technological progress, but began a dark era for worker's rights.

1900+

ANNEXED INTO PITTSBURGH, 1907

With Supreme Court approval in 1906, Allegheny City was annexed into Pittsburgh and became North Side. This was very unfavorable to the residents and local government, because Allegheny City had taken a much more planned approach to its development. This marked the beginning of a decline in the area.

URBAN EXPANSION, 1910

With a population explosion furthered by Pittsburgh's large-scale industry and its connection to the rest of America via railways, the area transformed from a small industrial town into an urban lanscape with a central city, suburban communities, satellite cities, and hundreds of isolated mining towns.

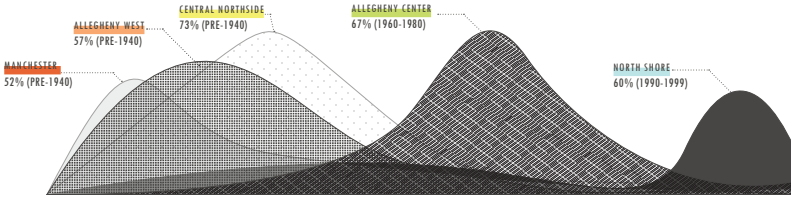
PEAK DISTRUBUTION OF EXISTING BUILDING CONSTRUCTION YEARS

The era in which many of the existing buildings within each neighborhood were constructed is indicative of the current character that the neighborhood maintains. They also reflect the era in which the neighborhood experienced its most growth either residentially or commercially.

PRESENT

GROWTH OF VEHICLES, 1940

Highways and vehicle transport became more prevalent, coinciding with a growth in public transportation and an overall tendency away from rail which transformed the North Side.

A NEW URBANISM, 1960-PRESENT

A large-scale demolition of historical buildings took place during the 1960s, as neighborhoods developed new master plans and began to resemble the public commercial areas they are today.